

MY HISTORY OF SPIRITUALITY

GOALS OF THE EXERCISE

1. Describe the story of the spiritual quest/journey.
2. Examine how life experiences have influenced beliefs about a higher power.
3. Take steps to deepen spiritual life.

ADDITIONAL PROBLEMS FOR WHICH THIS EXERCISE MAY BE MOST USEFUL

- Chemical Dependence
- Chemical Dependence—Relapse
- Depression
- Medical Issues
- Suicidal Ideation

SUGGESTIONS FOR PROCESSING THIS EXERCISE WITH THE CLIENT

Research has shown the positive impact that an active and meaningful spiritual life can have on physical and mental health. Explore the client's history of experiences with spiritual concepts and religious practices. Assist him/her in overcoming barriers to a deeper spiritual life if he/she shows an interest in pursuing this. Be respectful of the client's religious and spiritual preferences.

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2. **Where Am I Now Spiritually and How Did I Get Here?**

A. What do I currently believe about a higher power or God?

B. How are my thoughts about God as Father influenced by my experiences with my own father or mother?

C. How have my life experiences influenced my beliefs and feelings toward God?

D. What do I think prevents me from developing a more meaningful spiritual life?

E. What is the difference between spirituality and religion? Are they related?

F. What positive and negative experiences have I had with religious people?

G. Do I believe God is harsh and judgmental or loving and forgiving? How does my belief affect my spiritual relationship?

H. What three things could I do to make my life of faith and spirituality more meaningful?
